DESIGN THINKING - STAGE 3

UNDERSTAND → EMPATHIZE → IDEATE → PROTOTYPE → PITCH

Ideate

From evidence to a concept worth prototyping

We deliberately diverged beyond the first idea, challenged the seed, then converged using transparent criteria.

WHAT THIS READOUT SHOWS

- The HMW and research insights we started from
- How we generated 116+ ideas using multiple lenses
- How 12 ideas were shortlisted and scored
- Why My Wealth emerged as the concept to prototype
- What must still be tested before we call it a solution

Source of truth: docs/challenges/04-ideate.md + all 4 RBI Ideate prompt outputs on main.

We did not start with a solution

Stage 3 starts from the synthesized problem, not from “let’s build an AI bot”.

HOW MIGHT WE **Give mass-affluent customers outside full Premium advice clear, affordable guidance that starts from their own situation and is there when they choose to ask for it, so they can make confident investment decisions with their bank?**

1 LIFE-LED

Guidance should start from goals and life situation, not a product.

2 CUSTOMER CONTROL

Help when the customer asks; channel may be app or branch.

3 CLARITY + COST

Unclear/costly journeys push decisions to family, ChatGPT or cheaper providers.

4 REUSE CAPABILITY

My Life, RaiConnect, advisory tools and Learn to Invest already provide building blocks.

5 MULTIPLE ENTRY POINTS

Different customers need different paths; do not make AI mandatory.

Evidence base

2 experts + 2 street interviews + 1 UX study

Strong enough to ideate; not enough to claim customer validation.

Evidence is provisional; Stage 3 outputs are team inputs, not validated customer outcomes.

Our ideation process: diverge first, converge later

The workshop was designed to prevent the first idea from becoming the answer by default.

1

ALIGN

HMW + personas + journey + guardrails

2

DIVERGE

Reverse brainstorm + Crazy 8s + analogies

3

CHALLENGE

Build on / Break it - including our own seed idea

4

CLUSTER

Group similar ideas into themes

5

SELECT

Dot vote + impact/effort + multi-criteria scoring

90-minute workshop rules

- Defer judgment
- Build on others
- Wild ideas welcome
- Quantity before quality
- Everyone writes before discussion

Key facilitation move: the “Money Guide” was shown only as a seed to break, improve or replace.

RBI prompt 3.1.1: workshop design. Actual 90-minute agenda uses HMW split, reverse brainstorm, Crazy 8s, analogies, seed challenge, clustering and voting.

We opened the solution space before choosing

The goal was diversity: technology, process, human support, quick wins and bigger bets.

70	46	10	12	5
SOLUTION IDEAS	SCAMPER IDEAS	IDEA CATEGORIES	SHORTLISTED	TOP CLUSTER

Technology	Life Profile layer, AI explainer, cost comparer, handover
Process redesign	Life before product, no cold calls, fair exit, 3 paths
Human support	Expert on demand, branch support, yearly check-in
Hybrid	Self-service + expert escalation + context handover
Communication	Plain-language fees, contextual learning, decision clarity
Trust	Opt-in contact, control, transparent cost and risk
Cross-industry	Family doctor / telecom / tax software analogies
Unconventional	Bring your family, bring your ChatGPT answer, radical access
Quick wins	Booking questions, opt-in invitation, exit script
Strategic bets	Shared guidance desk, new service model, platform integration

3.2.1 generated 70 ideas across 10 lenses; 3.2.2 added 46 SCAMPER ideas by reworking the current journey.

We challenged our own “Money Guide” idea

The team seed was not treated as the winner; it had to survive the same criticism as everything else.

BREAK IT

Why might a customer reject it?

- Feels like another sales funnel
- AI may reduce trust for some customers
- Too many features at once
- Unclear legal line between explaining and recommending
- Branch-first customers may never enter the app

BUILD ON IT

What would make it simpler and safer?

- Life Profile before any product
- AI optional - human path always visible
- Show yearly costs and alternatives
- Pass context to the banker
- Use the same journey in branch

CREATE ALTERNATIVES

Ideas that do not depend on the seed

- Fair exit moment
- Standalone clear cost comparer
- Guidance desk for non-Premium
- Branch guide + printed plan
- Opt-in invitation / “you call us”

This “Build on / Break it” round was explicitly designed to avoid confirmation bias around the first team concept.

The 12 shortlisted ideas cover different moments in the journey

We kept stand-alone ideas and component ideas so the team could see what creates value by itself.

START / INVITATION		DECISION / GUIDANCE		HANDOVER / EXIT	
I-02	Life Profile before products	I-01	Money Guide - full bundle	I-05	Tell-it-once handover
I-10	Opt-in invitation	I-03	Clear comparer + yearly cost	I-04	Fair exit moment
I-09	Branch guide + printed plan	I-07	Ask an expert by tomorrow	I-11	Bring family / ChatGPT answer
I-06	Three help paths	I-08	Guidance desk for non-Premium	I-12	Paid one-off guidance session

Important: I-02, I-03, I-04, I-05 and I-10 can also be components of a larger concept - not only competitors.

We used explicit criteria instead of “I like this idea”

Scores are AI-assisted estimates on a small evidence base; the team still owns the decision.

30% — **Customer impact**

Does it help a confident, suitable decision?

15% — **Innovation**

Is it meaningfully different from current patterns?

25% — **Feasibility**

Can we test or implement it with realistic effort?

5% — **Strategic alignment**

Does it fit hybrid / reuse existing capability?

20% — **Retention impact**

Does it keep the bank in the customer relationship?

5% — **Risk**

Regulatory, privacy, reputation and adoption risk

Guardrail: “make customers invest more” is NOT a customer-impact criterion.

3.3.1 also checked alternative weightings, ICE, RICE, MoSCoW and risk. The same top cluster stayed broadly stable.

The top five were extremely close

That is a signal to combine the strongest elements - not pretend one score is “the truth”.



Only 0.50 points separate #1 from #5. In practice, these five form the strongest concept bundle.

With more weight on risk, the full Money Guide drops to 3rd because the AI component is the riskiest part.

Proposed concept to prototype: My Wealth

A concrete version of the team idea, built from the strongest-scoring components. Team confirmation is still needed.

MY WEALTH

New section inside the existing mobile app, unlocked when the customer enters the mass-affluent segment.

1. **Life Profile**
   Start from goals and situation
2. **Learn + Compare**
   Explain options and yearly cost
3. **Playground**
   Practice / simulate - keep simple
4. **AI Wealth**
   Optional explanation layer
5. **Expert**
   One tap, context passed to banker
6. **Fair Exit**
   Useful alternative at the moment of doubt

MY WEALTH

Wealth snapshot

€68,500

Life Profile | Learn

Playground | AI Wealth

Talk to an adviser

Core principle — **Self-service when I want independence. Human expertise when I need confidence.**

Illustrative UI preview from the separate My Wealth proposal deck. AI explains; the approved advisory process / banker recommends.

Before prototyping, strengthen the concept in seven places

Ideation did not end with “build this”. It surfaced the weaknesses we need to design around.

1

SHOW COSTS

Yearly cost + simple deposit / bond / fund comparison.

2

USE THE EXIT MOMENT

Offer a fair alternative or expert help when the customer is leaving.

3

BRANCH WAY IN

Same Life Profile on a banker tablet + one-page printed plan.

4

OPT-IN BELOW THRESHOLD

Let near-eligible customers request access instead of hard exclusion.

5

KEEP PLAYGROUND SIMPLE

Old simulator evidence says complexity can confuse.

6

LIFE PROFILE ≠ ADVICE

GDPR consent; formal MiFID / suitability remains later.

7

NUDGES ARE CUSTOMER-CONTROLLED

Choose topics and frequency; no cold calls.

Success = a confident, suitable decision

Keeping cash can still be the right answer.

These fixes come directly from the evidence and 3.3.1 scoring - especially cost, exit, channel choice and AI/regulatory risk.

Ideate is complete enough to move into Prototype & Test

The next phase is not “build the product” - it is “test the riskiest assumptions cheaply”.

UNDERSTAND → EMPATHIZE → IDEATE → **PROTOTYPE** → PITCH

UNLOCK	Does the message feel helpful or like sales?
LIFE PROFILE	Will customers complete it, and does the result feel accurate?
COST	Do they understand the comparison and what they pay?
HUMAN HELP	When do they press “Talk to an Expert”?
BRANCH	Would branch-trusting customers use the tablet / printed path?
AI	What can it legally explain, and do customers trust it?

NEXT DELIVERABLE

Clickable My Wealth prototype + 5–8 user tests

Core path: Unlock → Life Profile → Snapshot + costs → Learn → Expert handover

Stage 4 is ready to start; no prototype has been tested yet.